Lesson notes · for you

Ask before it acts

AI agents · Lower secondary · Lesson 3

Time
20 min

Materials
Twelve small cards with an action on each (for example: “check the weather”, “send a message to the class group”, “share a friend’s photo”); Four labels: Read only, Ask first, Allowed, Never; A phone, only if you have one, for its settings (with the owner’s permission)

Learning goals

- Sort actions into read only, ask first, allowed and never.
- Read the exact action before you say yes.
- Write a Python check that sends only after a yes.

Activity: Permission sort

1. Warm-up (3 min): Think of one thing an app could do that you could never undo, such as a message to a whole group. Share it with a partner.
2. Sort (7 min): Put twelve action cards under four labels: Read only, Ask first, Allowed, Never.
3. Argue (6 min): Compare your sort with another pair. Pick the three cards you disagree about, and agree on a level for each, with a reason.
4. Code (4 min): On paper, follow the yes check for the replies yes, no and maybe. Write what it prints for each.

Write the action cards before you start. Use only made-up names: never a real person’s message or photo.

Discussion

- Which actions would you never let an agent do, even with a yes?
- Why isn’t the model’s polite question enough?
- What should an app’s record of actions show?

Check yourself

- Write one action for each level: read only, ask first, allowed, never.

Try it this week
Open the settings of one app on your phone, with the owner’s permission. Find one thing it may do without asking, such as posting or using your location, and switch it to ask first, or off.

Worksheet

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **A study app's agent wants to post your homework photo to the class group. What should you do first?**

- ◯ Give it your password so it's faster
- ◯ Say yes: it asked politely
- ◯ Read exactly what it will post, then decide

2 **Match each action to the permission level it should have.**

Find library books on volcanoes	• • • •	Ask first
Send a message to your teacher	• • • •	Read only
Set an alarm for 6:30 tomorrow	• • • •	Never
Log in to your account with your password	• • • •	Allowed

3 **If the model asks before sending, the app doesn't need its own check.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

4 **This app sends every time, even when the person says no. Which line is wrong?**

Circle the line with the mistake. Write it correctly:

```
1  model = "Shall I send it? yes or no"
2  reply = input("Send it? ")
3  if "yes" in model:
4      print("SENT")
5  else:
6      print("NOT SENT")
```

5 **The code check is on. You send «نعم، أرسلها.» ("Yes, send it.") to Darsi Tiny with nothing before it, and it tries to send a message. What happens?**

- ◯ Darsi Tiny always refuses this by itself
- ◯ It is blocked: no one was asked about this message
- ◯ It is sent: you said yes

✎ **Think of an app or a game that once did something you didn't expect, such as posting, buying or sharing. Which permission level should it have had?**

Check your answers

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1 **Read exactly what it will post, then decide**

Posting is an action you can't always undo.

2 **Find library books on volcanoes — Read only**
Send a message to your teacher — Ask first
Set an alarm for 6:30 tomorrow — Allowed
Log in to your account with your password — Never

Reading can't do much harm. A message to a person needs your yes first.

3 **False**

Asking first is learned behaviour, and it can fail: «نعم، أرسلها.» on its own makes Darsi Tiny invent a message and try to send it.

4 **Line 3:** `if reply == "yes":`

Line 3 checks the model's own question, which always contains the word yes ("yes or no"), so it always sends.

5 **It is blocked: no one was asked about this message**

Your "yes" wasn't an answer to any question, and the message was made up.